



5G for neural manufacturing

TCS successfully used Airtel's 5G network to test its neural manufacturing solutions suite. <https://digit.in/jan22-15>



iPhone 14 to ditch the notch

The iPhone 14 is rumoured to get a punch-hole screen, and ditch the screen notch. <https://digit.in/jan22-16>

ASUS VivoBook 17 Ryzen 5 Hexa Core 5500U

Size above all

When the ASUS VivoBook 17 landed in our test centre, we had the same expectations from it that we usually have with a big-screen laptop. After using this laptop for over a week, and testing every bit of its functionality, here's what we think about it.

BUILD AND DESIGN

The ASUS VivoBook 17 is a big laptop in terms of length and height. Its 17-inch display towers in front of you. You can find plenty of real estate near the keys, which remain under-utilised. The keyboard feels adequate for its size but the trackpad could have been bigger.

The keys have good travel and the laptop's chassis is quite sturdy.

The ASUS VivoBook 17 comes with two speakers placed underneath the laptop. They are loud, but sound hollow and lack bass.

DISPLAY

The ASUS VivoBook 17 comes with a 17.3-inch FHD display with a 16:9 aspect ratio. In our display testing, we found that the laptop comes with 269 nits of peak brightness. Additionally, the laptop's screen has 63.9 percent sRGB coverage and 47.4 percent DCI P3 coverage. The RGB balance of the screen is towards a bluish tint. We also tested the laptop's screen for colour accuracy and during the ColorChecker analysis, we found an average DeltaE value of 5.4 and a max DeltaE value of 19.7, meaning that the display is not colour accurate.

PERFORMANCE

The ASUS VivoBook 17 packs in an AMD Ryzen 5 5500U APU, which stands for Accelerated Processing Unit. It packs the CPU and the GPU



on the same die. The CPU is a 6-core/12-thread unit and the GPU is a low-powered Radeon Graphics processor with 7 Graphics Core. With the introduction aside, let's take a look at the actual performance.

In the PC Mark 10 Extended benchmark, the laptop scored 4293. It scored high in "Essentials" and "Productivity" but had decent numbers in "digital content creation" and "gaming."

The AMD Ryzen 5 5500U chip scored 2362 in Cinebench R20 and 1161 and 3743 in single and multi-core performance in Cinebench R23 respectively. These are pretty good numbers and translate to similar real-world performance as well. When using Wondershare Filmora video editing software, the chip can render a 10-minute long 4K file at 60FPS with H.264 encoder and a bit rate of 80000 in around 39:39 minutes.

The laptop struggled when editing photos in the online photo editing app Vectr. We tried a number of tasks including resizing, cropping and the laptop struggled to keep up.

In terms of GPU performance and gaming, the AMD Ryzen 5 5500U took us by surprise. We ran the chip through 3d Mark's TimeSpy and Fire-

Strike and it scored pretty decently. We tested games like Valorant and Shadow of the Tomb Raider. The GPU delivered between 90-95 FPS in low settings at 1080p resolution in Valorant and 30 FPS at lowest setting while running Shadow of the Tomb Raider.

The ASUS VivoBook 17 is not built to play Cyberpunk 2077, but you can definitely enjoy some light gaming on it. Considering the kind of purpose it's mostly built for – productivity and daily usage – the kind of performance it delivers in games is quite good.

Our ASUS VivoBook 17 review unit came with 16GB DDR4 RAM and under most conditions with a few tabs open and another two or three apps running in the background, its usage stays at around 50 percent. Considering the kind of performance, the 16GB memory should make this laptop quite future proof.

VERDICT

From these tests, it is clear that the ASUS VivoBook 17 is a jack of all trades and a master of none. It features a

power-efficient yet capable entry-level APU, a decent amount of storage, good battery life and a big screen. It can play games, but not at the highest graphical preset, you can watch videos on it for hours but not in 4K resolution and its keyboard is great but the trackpad could have been bigger.

If you're looking to buy a general-purpose laptop for a big screen for Rs 61,990, then the ASUS VivoBook 17 is a decent choice. But if you're willing to opt for a smaller screen then you can get pretty much a similarly performing laptop for much cheaper.

—Yetnesh Dubey

SPECIFICATIONS

CPU: AMD Ryzen 5 5500U 6-Core 12-Thread CPU with 2.1GHz base clock, 4.0GHz boost clock and 15W TDP | GPU: AMD Radeon Graphics Processor with 7 Graphics Core and 1800MHz graphics frequency | RAM: 16GB DDR4 RAM | STORAGE: 512GB SSD Storage | DISPLAY: 17.3-inch FHD display | WEIGHT: 2.3kg | BATTERY SIZE: 65Wh

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